



ENTERPRISE AI AGENTS

Build vs Buy: The CTO decision framework.

Swipe →





THE SITUATION



Vendor demos pass. **Production fails.**

- Demos run on public model endpoints
- Retain conversation state beyond your policy
- No audit trail for regulated workloads
- Your compliance team says no. Again.





BUILD CASE



Build when control is non-negotiable.

- Data cannot touch third-party inference
- Audit trail must meet SOC 2 or FINRA spec
- Workflow logic is proprietary competitive moat
- You have a team that can own the stack





BUY CASE



Buy when speed beats specificity.

- Generic workflow: support, summarization, drafting
- Data is not regulated or customer-sensitive
- Speed to value beats total cost of ownership
- No internal ML or AI ops headcount available





THE HYBRID ANSWER



Most fintechs need both layers.

- Managed API for low-sensitivity tasks
- Private inference for regulated workloads
- Agent orchestration layer owned internally
- Vendor evaluations scoped to specific use cases





COST REALITY



The gap between pilot and production.

- Pilot cost is rarely total cost
- Model inference at scale adds up fast
- Compliance infra and audit tooling underestimated
- Reviewer and escalation ops cost as much as the model





5 questions for any AI vendor.

- Where does inference happen and who sees the data?
- What does the audit trail look like under exam?
- What is the SLA for regulated production workloads?
- Who owns the model when fine-tuning happens?





DECISION FRAMEWORK



One filter for every decision.

- If data is regulated: private inference required
- If workflow is generic: use managed API
- If logic is proprietary: build the orchestration
- If team is small: build the evaluation, buy the inference





CODISTE AI

Need a build vs buy assessment for your team?

Talk to us ↗

codiste.com